

How to use Hope Beacon

An illustrated walk through the app, for the people using it

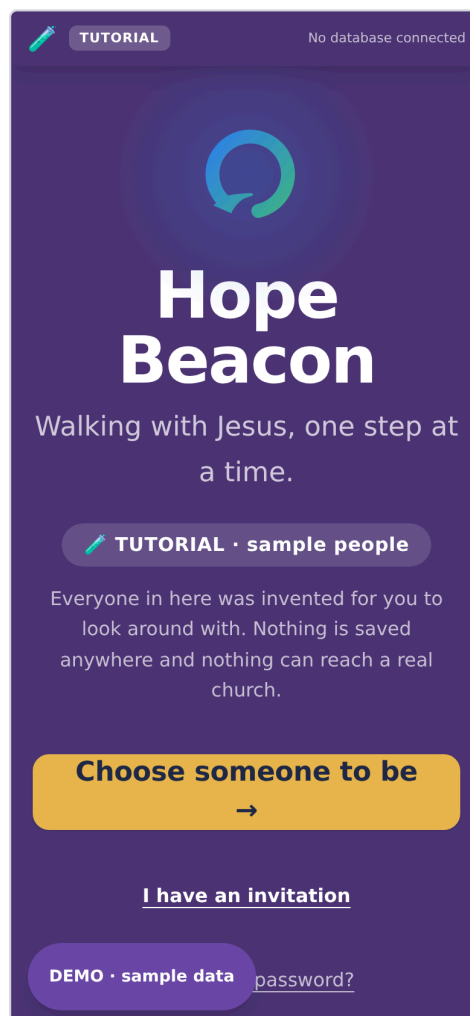
Every picture here is the real app, photographed on a phone-sized screen. Nothing is drawn or mocked up. The sample names you will see (John, Maria, Pastor Ramos) are the demo's own people, not anybody in your church.

If you only read one page, read **Part 2**. That is the whole app for most people.

Part 1 — Getting it on your phone

Hope Beacon is a website that behaves like an app. There is nothing to find in the App Store or Play Store, and nothing to pay for. You open a link once and then keep it on your home screen.

The link, and what you see first



The front door. Anybody can open this; it is the only page that does not need an account. I have an invitation is the way in.

Install it, so it opens like an app

Installing means the app gets its own icon, opens without the browser's address bar, and remembers you. It is the same app either way, only tidier.

On an iPhone or iPad (Safari)

1. Open the link in **Safari**. It has to be Safari; Chrome on an iPhone cannot install a web app.
2. Tap the **Share** button at the bottom of the screen (the square with an arrow coming out of the top).
3. Scroll down the list and tap **Add to Home Screen**.
4. Tap **Add**. The icon appears with your other apps.

On an Android phone (Chrome)

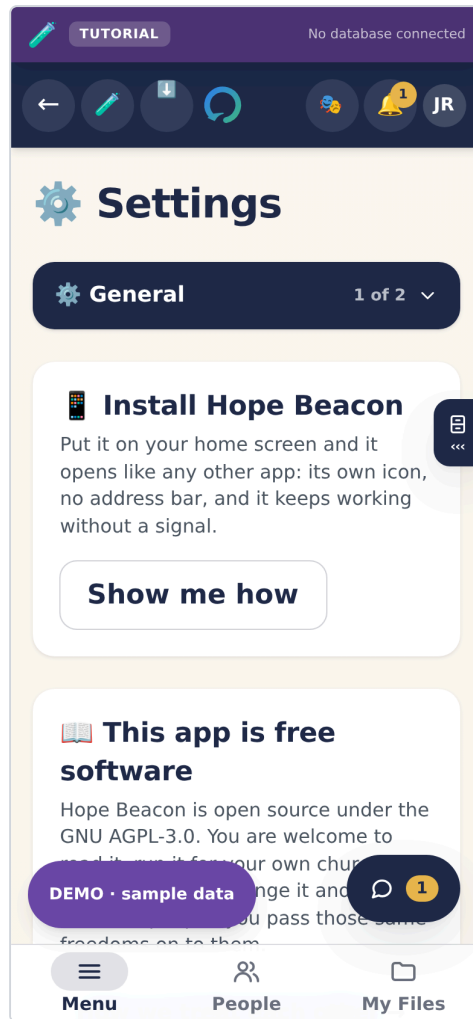
1. Open the link in **Chrome**.
2. Tap the **three dots** at the top right.
3. Tap **Add to Home screen**, then **Install**.

On a computer

Chrome and Edge show a small install icon at the right-hand end of the address bar. Safari on a Mac has **File** → **Add to Dock**.

If you are asked to sign in again after installing, that is normal once. The installed copy starts its own session. It will remember you afterwards.

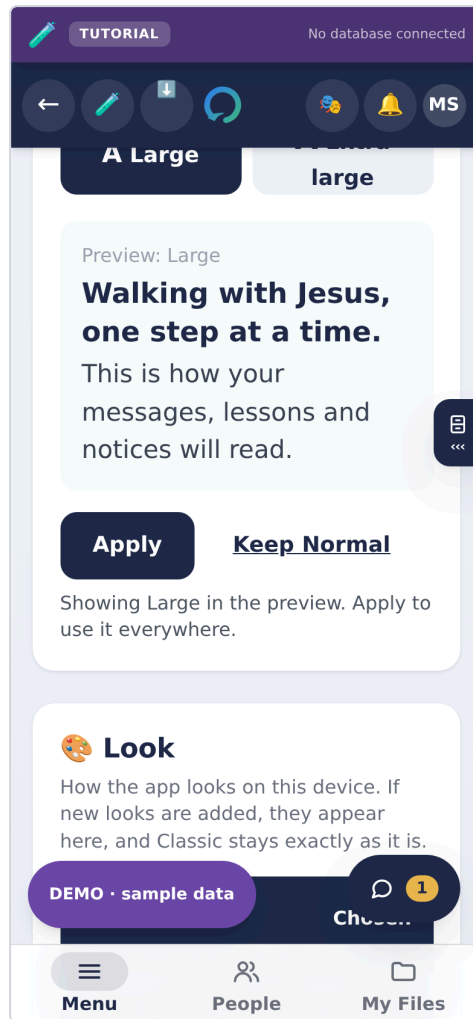
Everything to do with installing also lives inside the app, under Settings, so nobody has to keep this page to hand:



Settings. Installing, alerts, text size and language all live here, in the General folder.

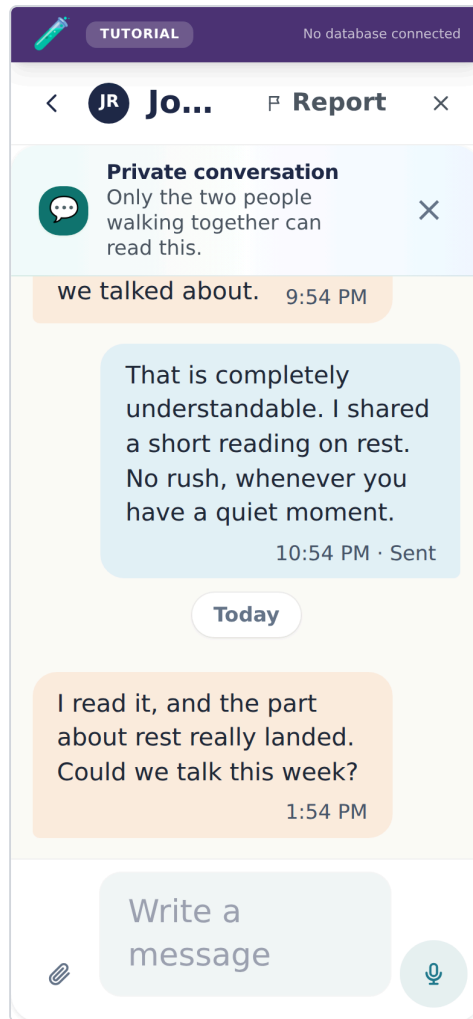
Bigger words

If the writing is too small, open **Settings**, stay in **General**, and choose a larger **Text size**. The preview below the sizes shows it first; when it reads well, press **Apply**, and every screen follows it, conversations included.



Text size. Large is tried in the preview; Apply makes it the size everywhere, Keep Normal leaves it as it was.

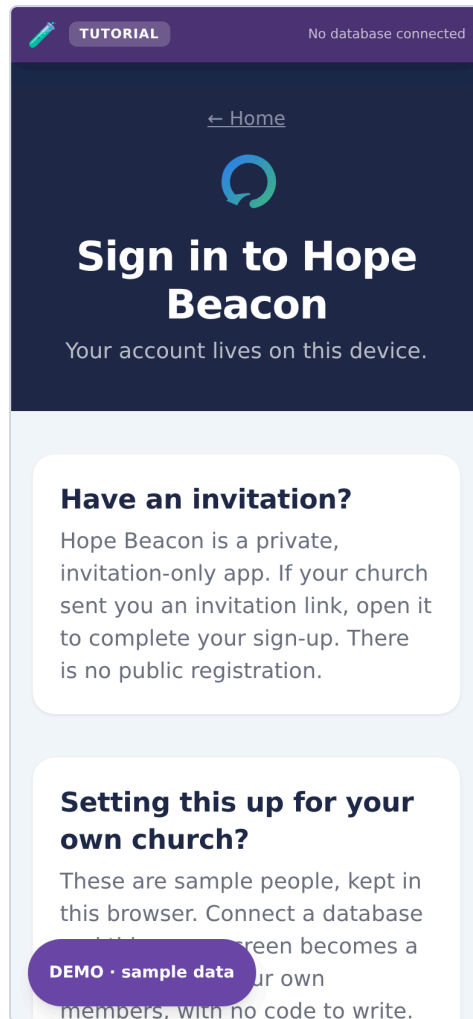
Just below it is **Look**, with **Classic** chosen. On a computer, Classic has your rooms down the left side and a light bar across the top; on a phone or tablet, the bar along the bottom. If new looks are added, you can pick one there.



A conversation with Text size at its largest. The words grow and still fit the screen.

Signing in

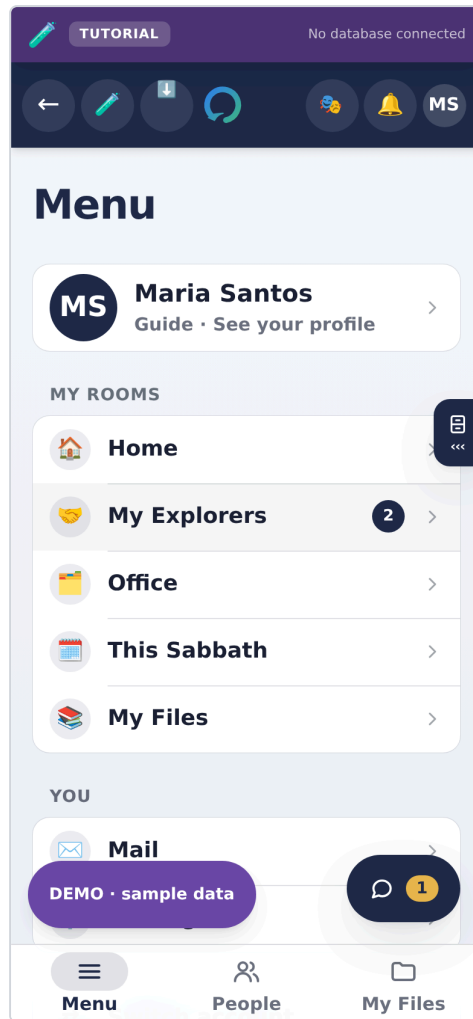
You need an invitation from your church. When you have one, you pick who you are and the app takes you to your own part of it.



Signing in. There is no public sign-up: if you have no invitation yet, ask your church for one.

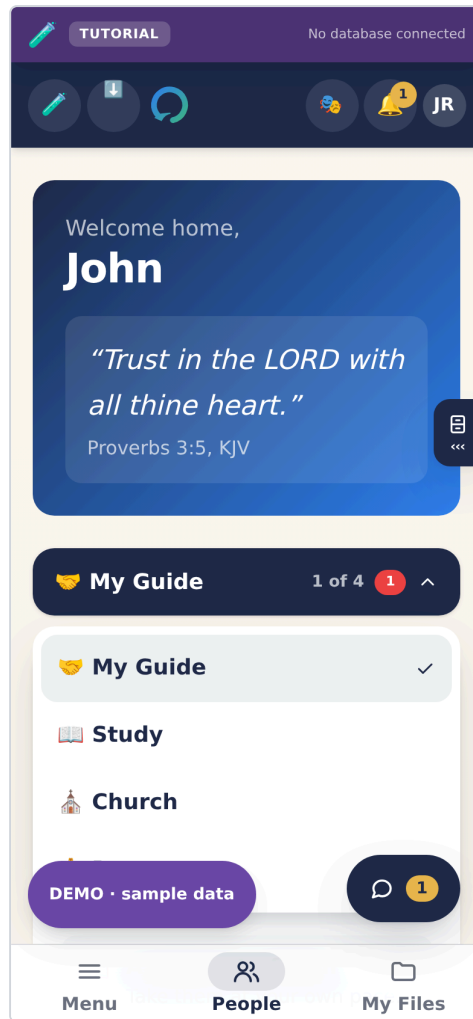
Finding your way

Along the bottom of every screen are three words. **Menu** lists every place you can go, written out. **People** opens the people you walk with. **My Files** opens your own files.



The Menu. Every room is written out, with your own profile at the top.

Some screens hold several **folders**. The button at the top names the one you are in and how many there are; tap it to see them all, then tap one to go there.



A folder list, open. It says you are in My Guide, 1 of 4, and lists the rest.

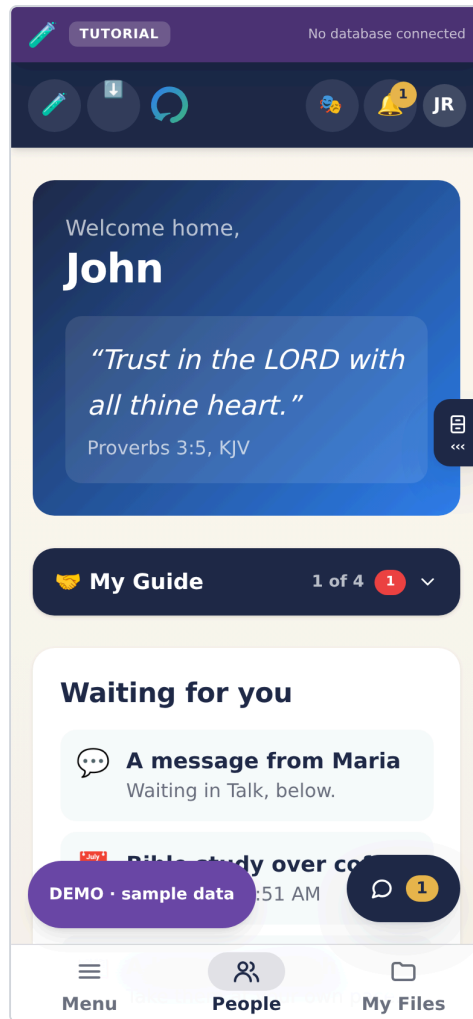
Part 2 — If you are an Explorer

An Explorer is somebody the church is walking with. You have one Guide, and the app is built around that one relationship.

Your screen has four folders: **My Guide**, **Study**, **Church** and **Prayer**. Tap the button at the top to go straight to one. You never have to scroll a long page looking for something.

My Guide

Your Guide, and anything waiting from them. Your conversation with them is the round **Talk** button in the corner of every screen, with a number on it when they have written. It is private between the two of you. Church leaders cannot read it.



My Guide. What is waiting for you, and a reminder of where the conversation is.

Talking with your Guide

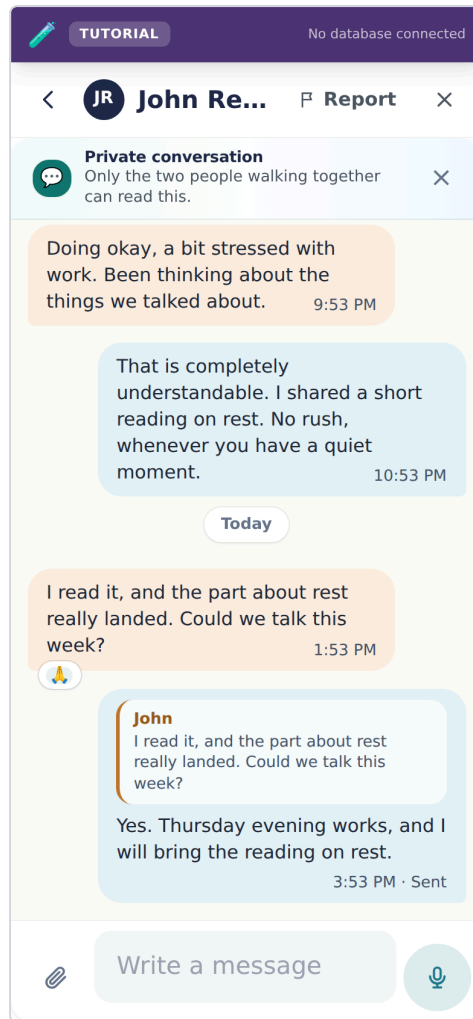
Type in the box at the bottom and press the arrow. The paper clip sends a photo or a file.

Tap a message to react to it or reply to it. Holding it does the same.



Tap a message: six reactions along the top, then Reply and Copy. Edit and Delete appear on your own messages.

- **React** with one tap. The praying hands come first, because that is the one people reach for most. Tap the same one again to take it back.
- **Reply** to answer one message in particular. Your answer carries a quote of it. Swiping a message to the right does the same.



A reply, with the message it answers quoted above it. The praying hands under the earlier message are a reaction.

Say it instead of typing it. When the box is empty, the button beside it is a microphone. Tap it once and speak; the phone asks for the microphone the first time. Tap the arrow to send, or the bin to throw it away. It stops at two minutes and never sends on its own.

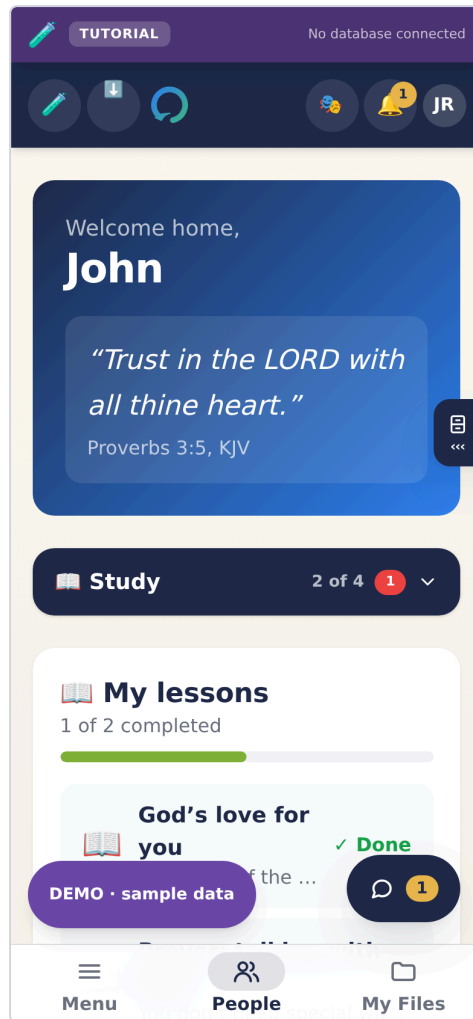


Recording a voice message. The clock counts while you speak; the bin throws it away, the arrow sends it.

If you do not see Reply, the reactions or the microphone, your church has not switched them on yet. Everything else in the conversation works the same.

Study

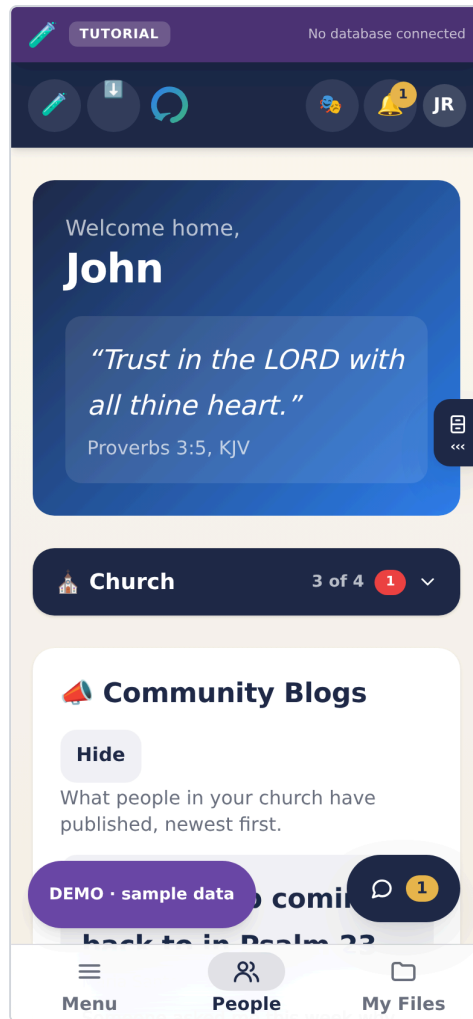
The lessons your Guide has sent you, in the order they sent them. There is no schedule and nothing you are behind on. Open one, read it, and mark it done when you have finished.



Study. Your lessons, at your own pace.

Church

What the whole church is saying: notices, and anything the Guides have written for everybody. You can read it without owing anyone a reply.

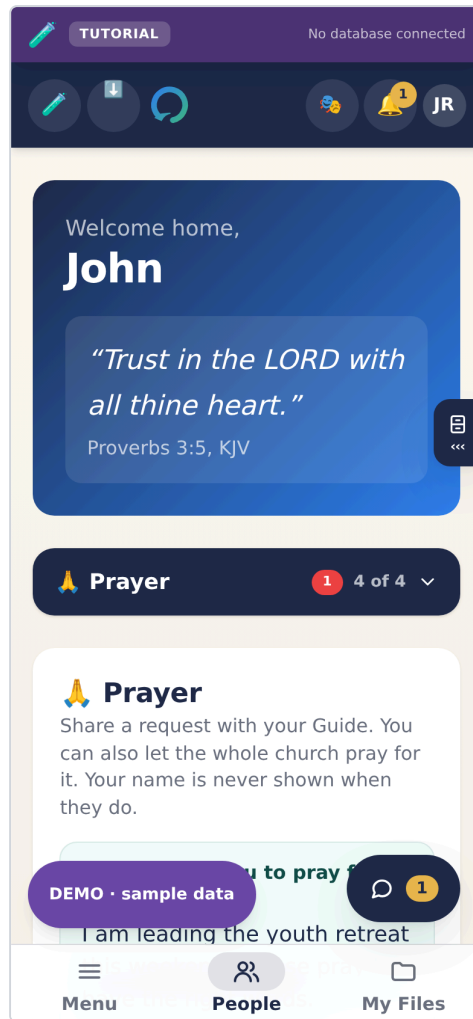


Church. Notices and writing from the church, in your own time.

Prayer

Ask for prayer. By default your request goes to your Guide alone. If you tick the box, the whole church can pray for it, and **your name is never shown when they do**.

Your Guide can ask you to pray for them too. It shows at the top of Prayer. Press **I am praying for this** and they are told. If something in it worries you, **Report** is on the same card.

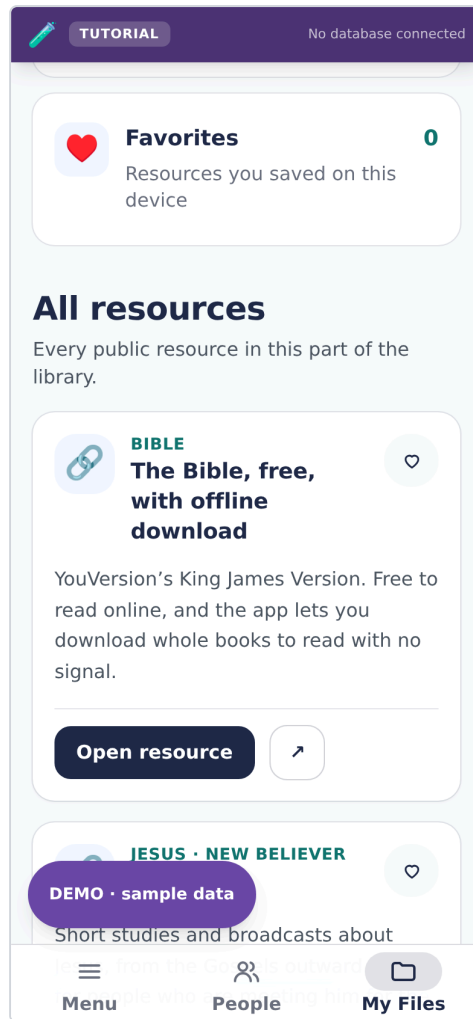


Prayer. Your request goes to your Guide unless you choose otherwise.

Your shelf

Eight things to read and watch, in the order we would hand them to you. A Bible you can read on a phone, then Jesus, then a way into studying for yourself, and then what this church teaches.

Nothing is hidden. Everything your Guide can see, you can find too. This is simply where we would start.



The shelf. Eight resources, and it opens with a Bible and with Jesus.

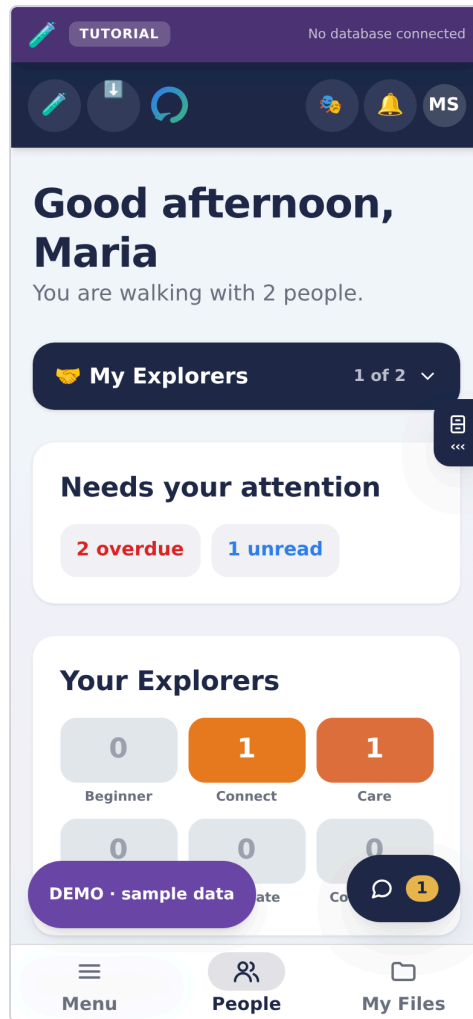
Tap the heart on anything to keep it on your own device, so it opens with no signal.

Part 3 — If you are a Guide

A Guide walks with up to the number of Explorers the church has set. It is a limit the app enforces, not a suggestion: somebody carrying forty names is not walking with anybody.

Your desk

Everyone you walk with, and what needs you today.



A Guide's desk. Who you walk with, and what is waiting.

Talking with somebody

Open a person and press **Message**, or use the round **Talk** button in the corner. It is private between the two of you. You can attach a photograph or a file, and photographs are made smaller and have their location removed before they are sent. Replying, reacting and voice messages work as they do for an Explorer (Part 2).

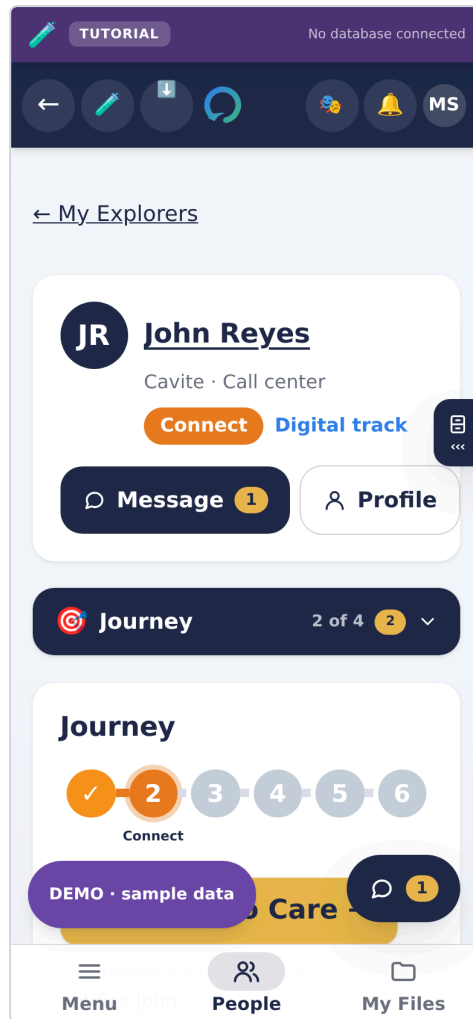


A conversation. The line at the top says it: only the two people walking together can read it.

Prayer runs both ways. On a person's **Care** tab you can read what they asked and tell them you are praying, and ask them to pray for you. Only they see what you ask, and you see when they are praying for it.

Moving somebody along

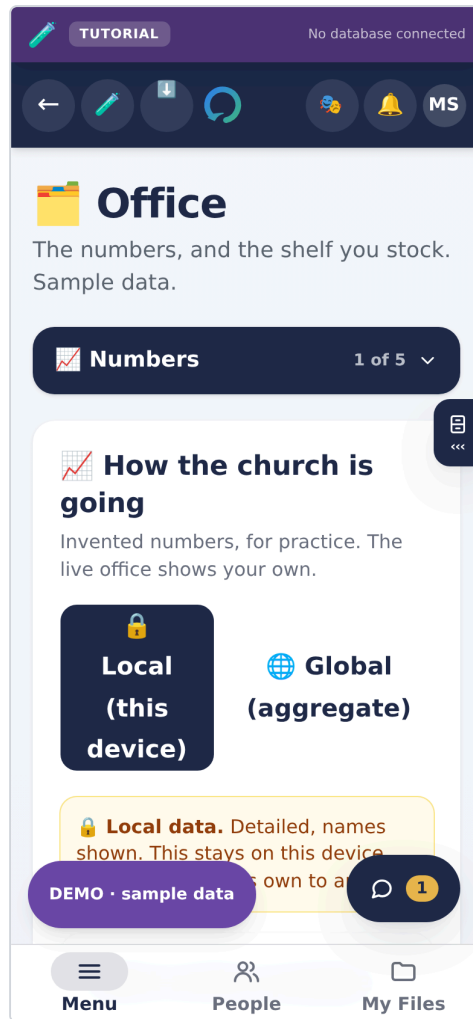
The Journey tab is where you record where somebody has reached, and send them the next lesson.



*The journey. Where somebody has reached, and
what comes next.*

The Office

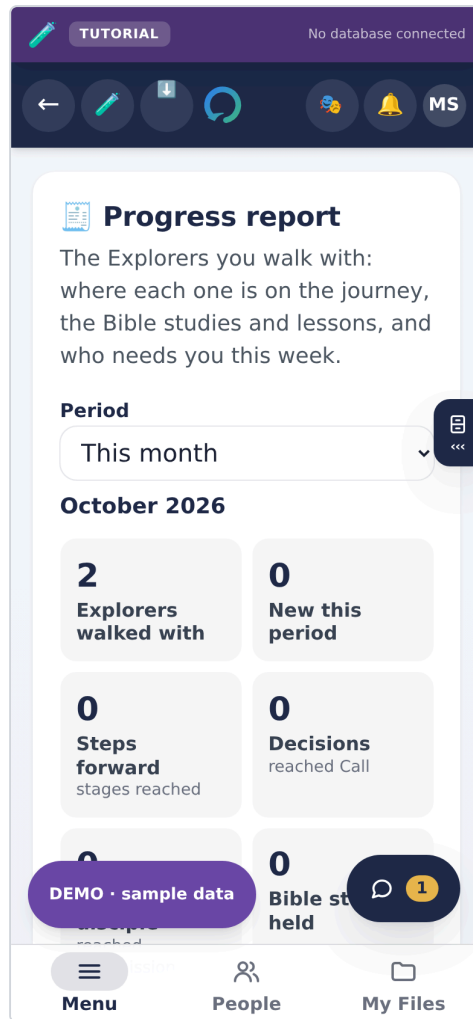
Everything that is your work rather than your conversation: lesson studies, the Sabbath program, evangelistic meetings, resources, the Guides' room, putting a name forward, and your progress report. Each is a subroom, so you tap once and you are there.



The Office in the sample church, open on Numbers.
The sample has five of its folders; your church's Office has them all.

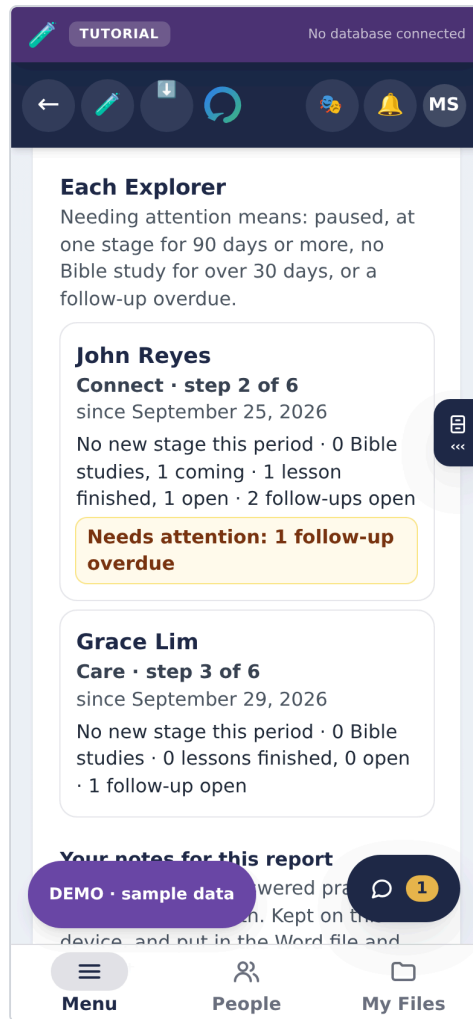
Your progress report

Reports, in the Office, shows how the Explorers you walk with are doing, for this month, last month, this quarter or last quarter. Choose one under **Period**.



The progress report. How many you walk with, who moved a step, and the Bible studies held.

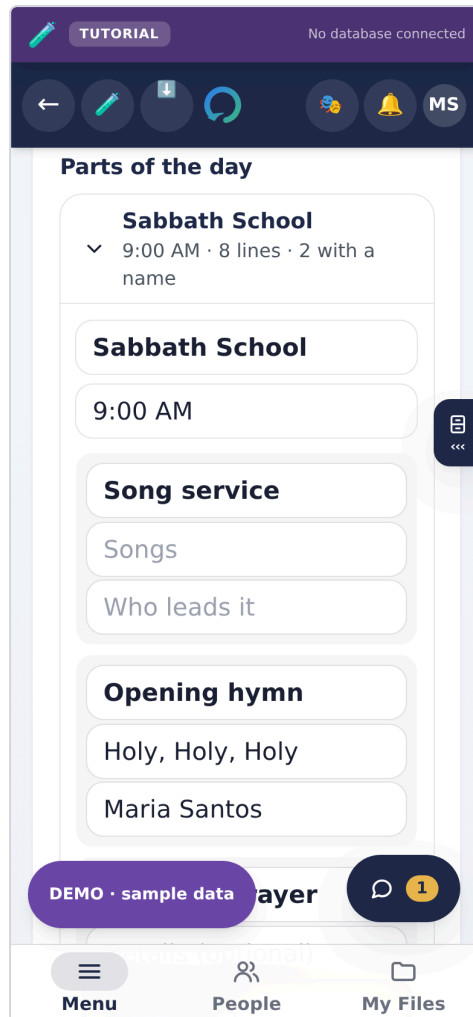
- The numbers at the top: how many you walk with, who is new, the steps forward, decisions, Bible studies held, lessons finished and follow-ups done.
- **Each Explorer:** where they are on the journey and what this month held. Anybody who needs you comes first, with the reason in words, such as "1 follow-up overdue" or "No Bible study for 35 days".
- **Your notes for this report:** what the numbers miss, such as an answered prayer. They stay on your phone and go into the Word file.
- **Download Word file** or **Copy as text** to hand it in.



Each Explorer, and who needs attention.

The Sabbath program

The **Sabbath program** folder in the Office plans a Sabbath's order of service. Press **New program**. It starts with Sabbath School, the Divine Service, the afternoon program and sunset vespers, ready for names. Type who leads each part, and the hymn or passage if you like. Tap a part of the day to open it. Under the date it says how many lines still need somebody.



The Sabbath program. Each line says what happens, which hymn or passage, and who leads it.

- **Download Word file** gives you a file that opens in Word, in Pages, and in Google Docs (upload it to Google Drive, or open it in the Google Docs app).
- **Download picture** gives you a picture of the program for a group chat. On a phone, **Share the picture** sends it straight to Messenger, Viber or email.
- **Copy as text** is for pasting into a group chat.
- **Post it**, under **Share in the app**, puts it in the app for the people you walk with, or for everyone in the church. They find it on **This Sabbath**, in the Menu.
- **Reuse next week** starts next week's program from this one, names and all.
- **Arrange lines**, under a part, is for moving a line or taking it out.
- **Folder** keeps programs in order: type a name such as "Quarter 4", and the list groups them.
- **Add to calendar** puts each part of the day that has a time on your phone's calendar.

To design it in Canva, a free account is enough. In Canva, choose **Upload** and add the picture or the Word file. The app does not connect to Canva.

Advanced settings, a tick box above your programs, adds more:

- **Minutes** for each line, so each line shows when it starts. If one part runs into the next, the program tells you.

- **A note** on any line, for the people on the platform. Choose **For the platform, with times and notes** before you download to get a copy with them. The copy for the congregation, the picture and the post never have the notes.
- **Your own details**, for anything the boxes do not cover, such as "Deacons on duty". Press **Add a detail**, give it a name, and write what it says. It prints under the theme.
- **Save as a template**, to start next time from your own layout.
- **Reminders**: everyone named, each with a message ready to copy and send.

TUTORIAL No database connected

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Opening hymn

Holy, Holy, Holy

Maria Santos

5 starts 9:15 AM

Pianist plays the first verse through

Opening prayer

Details (optional)

John Reyes

3 starts 9:20 AM

Note for the platform

DEMO · sample data

Menu People My Files

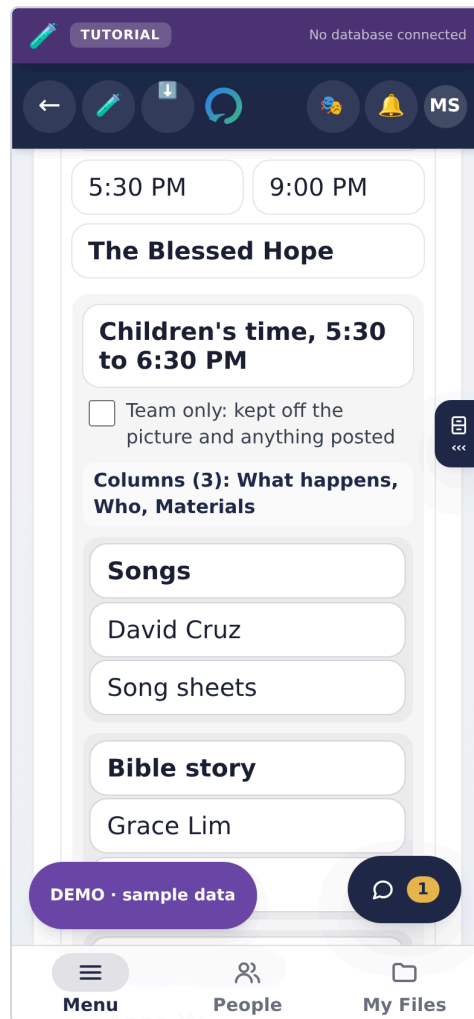
Advanced settings. Each line has its minutes, when it starts, and a note for the platform.

Your programs are saved on your phone or computer as you type, and work with no signal. In your church's app they also follow you to any phone or computer where you sign in. Nobody else sees them until you post them or download them. Directors have the same folder.

Evangelistic meetings

The **Evangelistic meetings** folder in the Office plans a series of meetings your own way. Press **New meetings**, choose the first night and how many nights, then **Start with a plan** or **Start blank**. The plan gives each night from 5:30 to 9:00 PM: children's time (songs, a Bible story, craft making), health time, Bible study, and snacks, plus a team and a to-do list. Change any of it.

- Tap a night to open it. Give it a date, when it starts and ends, and a topic.
- **Add a block** puts a program, a team, a schedule, a list, a paragraph or a checklist on a night or on the whole series. **Arrange blocks** moves them.
- A list's **Columns** lets you name its columns yourself, up to six.
- **Copy to a new night** makes the next night from this one.
- **Its look** chooses a colour, a heading style, and where the name sits, for the Word file and the picture.
- Tick **Team only** on anything that is not for the public. It stays out of the picture and anything you post.
- **Folder** keeps many series in order, such as "Youth Week".



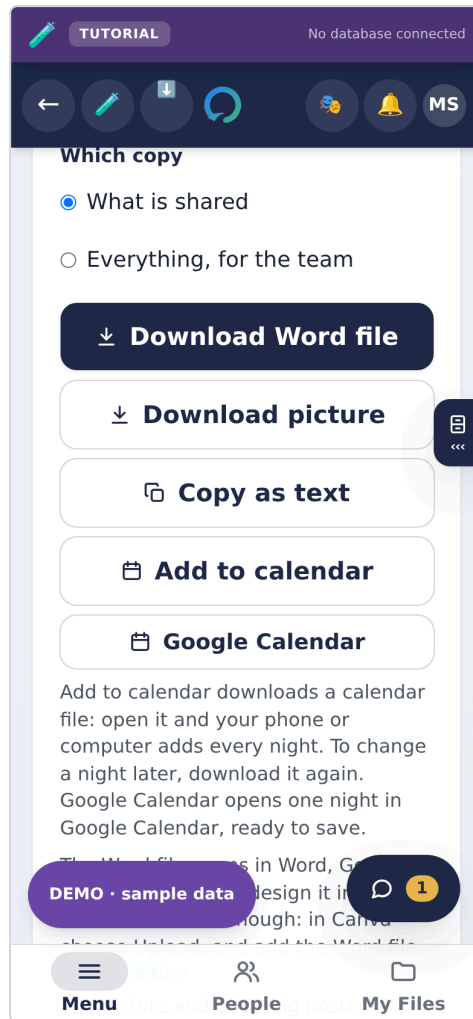
*Evangelistic meetings. A night's children's time,
with a column you added yourself.*

Under **Take it away**, choose the whole series or one night, then download a Word file or a picture, or **Post it** for the people you walk with or the whole church.

On your calendar, and on your other devices

Add to calendar downloads a calendar file. Open it and your phone or computer adds every night (or each part of a Sabbath program that has a time). On an iPhone it is one tap. On a computer, Google Calendar takes it under **Settings, Import**. If you change a night, download it again.

Google Calendar appears when you choose one night: it opens Google Calendar with that night filled in, ready to save.

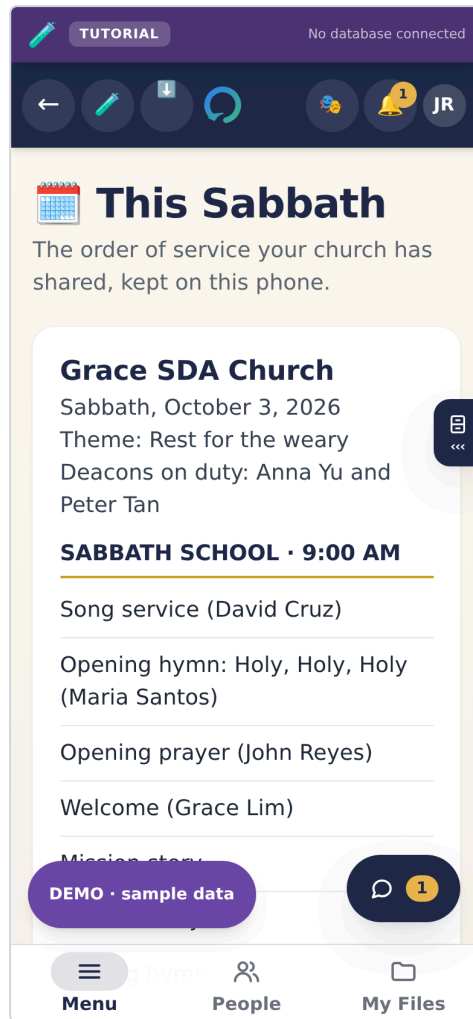


Add to calendar and Google Calendar, under Take it away.

On another phone or computer, sign in with the same account and open the Office: in your church's app, your programs and meetings are there. Under **Saved** it says whether they have reached your account yet. With no signal, they wait on the phone and go up by themselves when the signal comes back.

This Sabbath

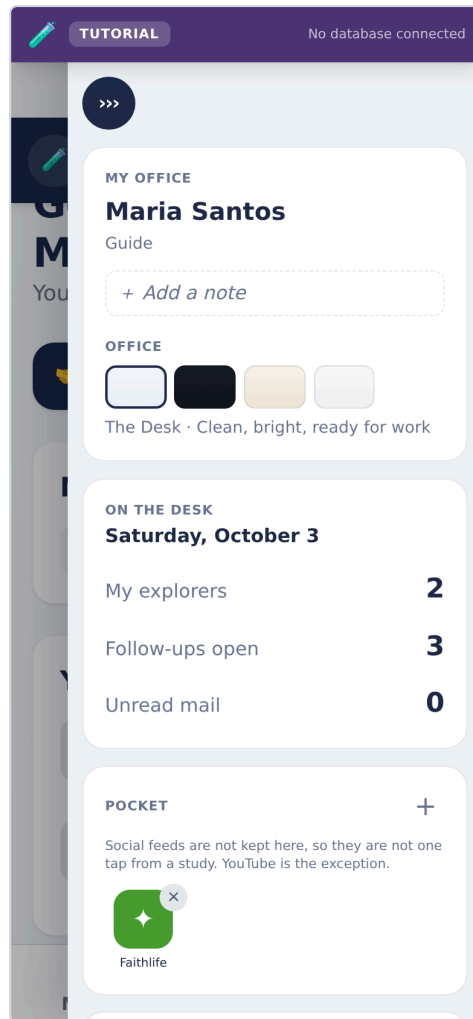
This Sabbath, in the Menu, shows the Sabbath program your Guide or your church has posted, with who shared it, and any evangelistic meetings they have posted. Once you have opened it with a signal, it opens again with none, so you can read it in a church hall without signal.



This Sabbath on a phone. The church, the date, the theme, then each part of the day and who leads it.

Your desk drawer

On a phone, your desk is a drawer. Tap the small cabinet on the right edge, or swipe in from that edge: the date, what is waiting, a note to yourself, and a pocket of links. Tap >>> to put it away.

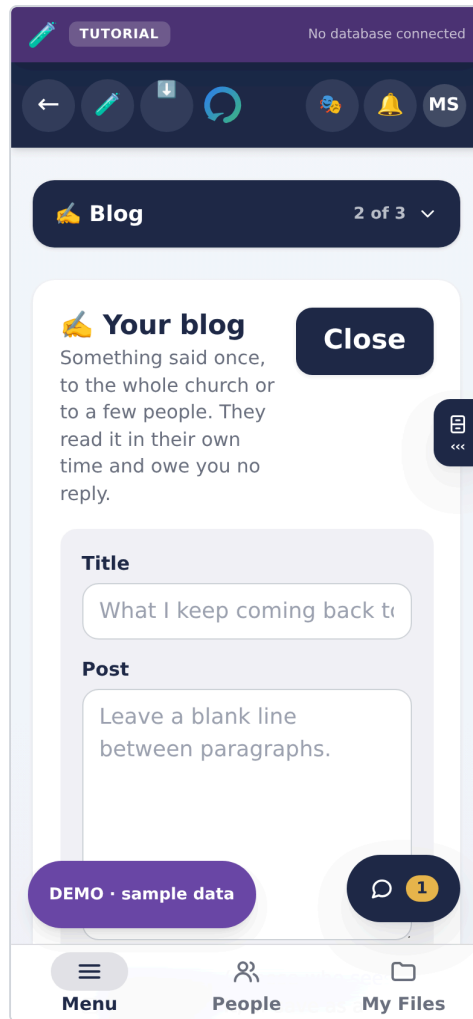


The desk drawer, open: today's date, what is waiting, a note, and the pocket.

Writing for the church

Open **Home**, then the folder button at the top, and choose **Blog**. The writing box is already open: give it a title, write, and press **Publish**. Everybody in the church reads it, with your name on it. Tick **Advanced settings** to send it only to the people you walk with, or to people you choose, or to **Save as draft**.

To pin a notice at the top of everybody's Home, choose **Announcements** instead: a title, the words, **Pin it**. **Advanced settings** adds when it happens, such as "This Sabbath, 9:00 AM". Take a notice down from **Notices**, beside the notice itself.



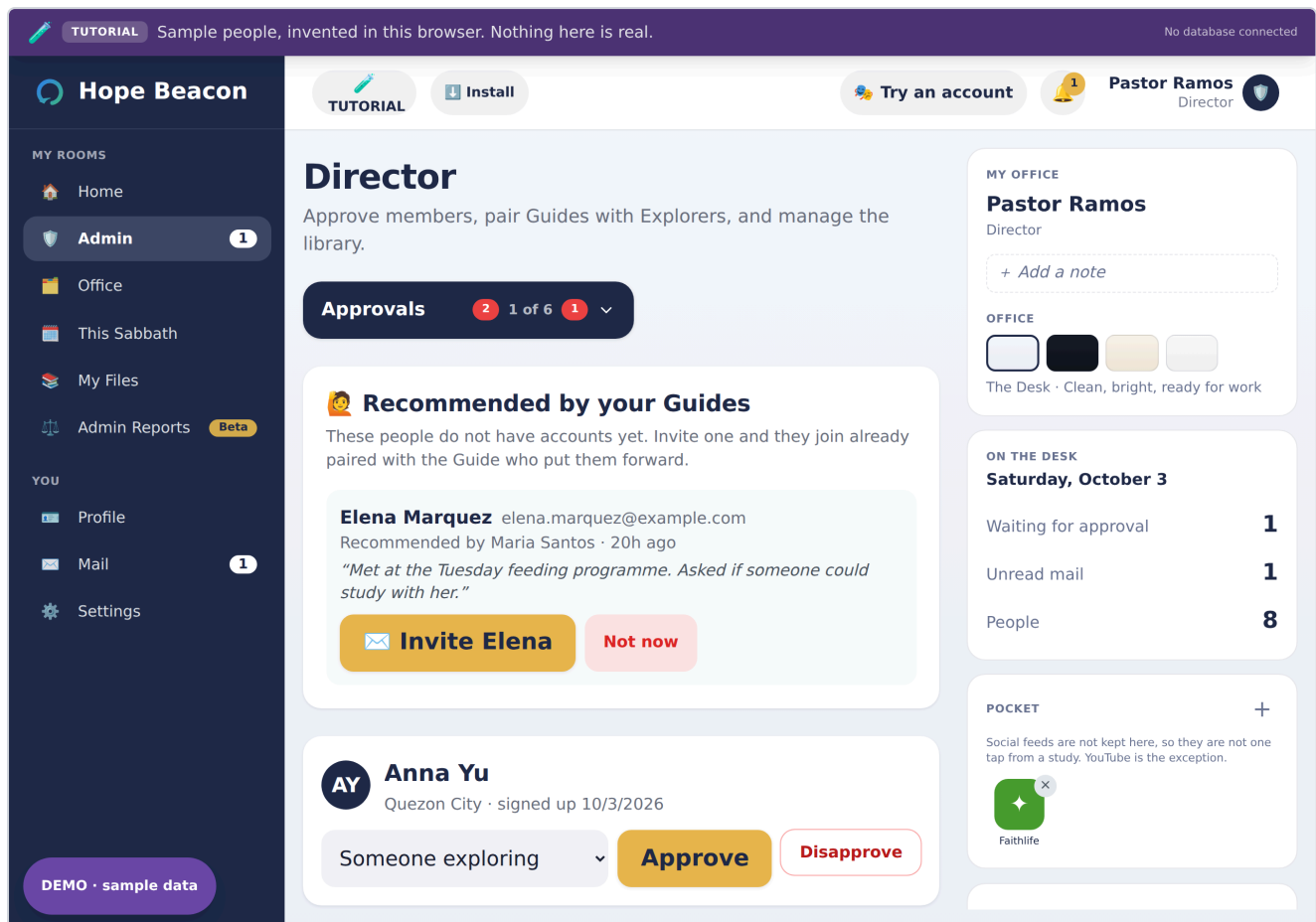
Home, Blog. The writing box is open as soon as you arrive; what the church wrote is below it.

Part 4 — If you are a Director

Directors run the church's account: who gets in, and who walks with whom.

Who is waiting

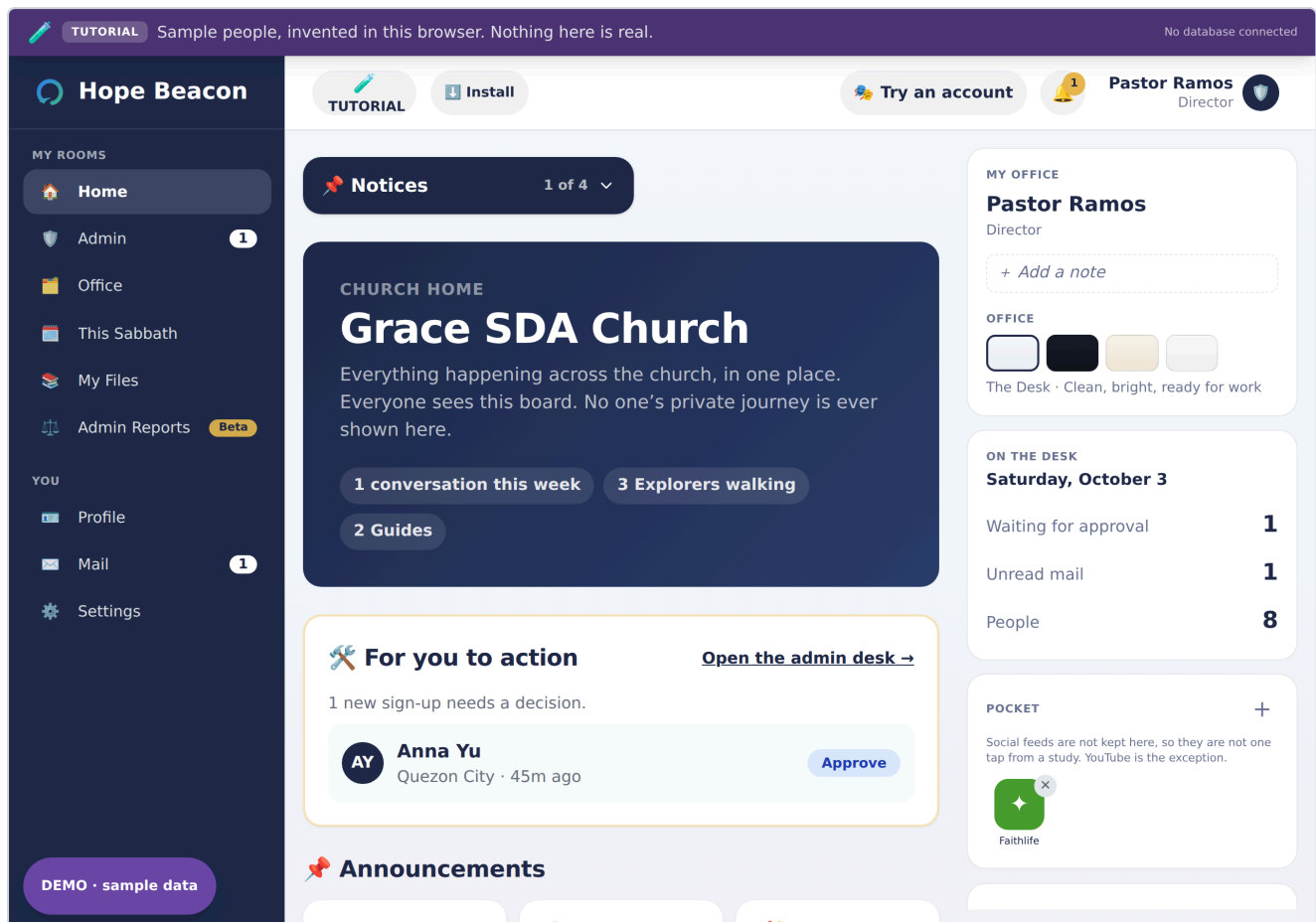
The single most important screen in the app. **An Explorer with no Guide has no app**, so anything above zero here is somebody being ignored.



Approvals. Who is waiting to be let in, and who is waiting to be paired.

The church home

Notices, your **Blog**, **Announcements**, the prayer wall, and the numbers.



The church home.

Four questions, once a week, five minutes:

1. Is anybody unpaired?
2. Is any Guide at their limit of five while Explorers wait?
3. Is any guild flagged "Needs a look"?
4. Is there anything in the trial room?

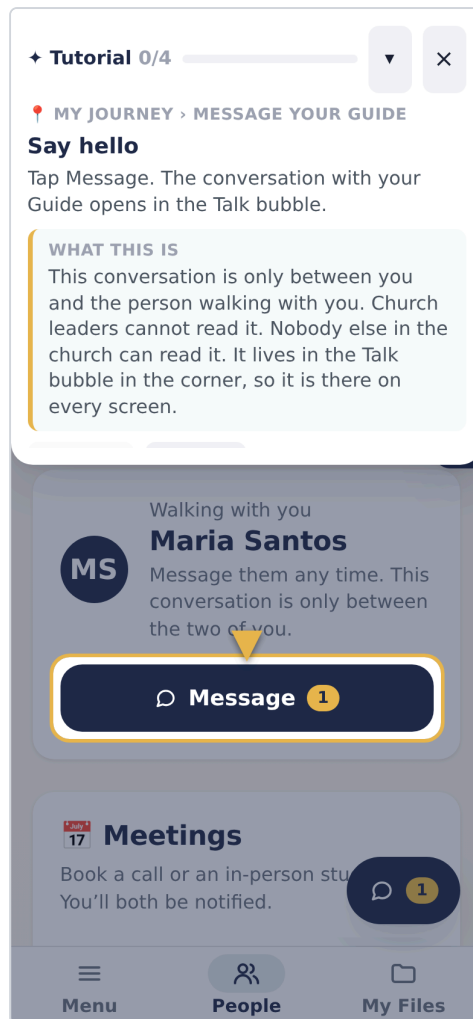
Without that rhythm the numbers are decoration.

The progress report

Reports, in the Office, shows every Explorer in the church by stage and by Guide, for a month or a quarter, with who needs somebody to look. Bible studies, lessons and follow-ups stay between each Guide and Explorer, so they are in each Guide's own report, not yours. Ask a Guide for theirs.

Part 5 — The guided walk

If you would rather be shown than told, the app will walk you through your own part of it. Pick who you are on the front door and follow the highlight. It points at the next thing to tap, and explains what it is before you tap it.



The guided walk. It highlights the next thing, and says what it is for.

It takes two or three minutes, uses safe sample data, and nothing you press reaches a real person.

If something looks wrong

- **A blank screen, or something out of place after an update.** Close the app fully and open it again. It checks for a new version each time it starts.
- **You cannot find a button somebody told you about.** Check which folder you are in. Tap the button at the top of the screen; what you want may be in another folder.
- **The app says your invitation is not valid.** Invitations expire. Ask your church for a new one.
- **You changed your profile picture and the old one is still showing.** Close and reopen the app once.

Anything else, use **Send feedback** at the bottom of the front door. It takes a sentence.